

E I R I S

GREEK MYTHOLOGY



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Most erinyes were the descendants of fallen angels while others were their still-living ancestors having survived to become brachinas. With the Ascension of Asmodeus, the erinyes received mastery over the succubi, but received a terrifying transformation.

VOLUME

1

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W E A R E

ISIS, EIRIS, MORIS

In this volume, we journey to sun-soaked shores and stormy peaks, where gods once walked among mortals and destiny was written in the stars. This is EIRIS, the Greek mythology chapter of our magazine – a tribute to epic tales, divine drama, and the endless echo of ancient voices.

Greek mythology has always felt like a vivid dream – full of passion, chaos, revenge, beauty, and transformation. These are the stories that shaped cultures, inspired generations of thinkers, poets, and artists, and continue to live on in surprising ways. From the tragic fall of Icarus to the defiance of Prometheus, the cunning of Odysseus, and the sorrow of Persephone – these myths are more than just stories. They're reflections of human nature, wrapped in the grandiose forms of gods and monsters.

For this issue, we (Lili, Nina, and Zuzana – or Isis, Eiris, and Moris) dove deep into this rich ocean of mythology, bringing our own visual interpretations and storytelling quirks to life. With Nina (Me) leading the way on this volume, her passion for mythology, her eye for striking symbolism, and her playful yet profound storytelling have shaped the soul of this chapter.

EDITOR - NINA MONDOČKOVÁ



This issue isn't about retelling the myths exactly as they've always been told – it's about seeing them through new eyes. What if Medusa wasn't just a monster, but a misunderstood woman cursed by the gods? What if the labors of Heracles were less about brute strength and more about the weight of redemption? What if these stories still have something urgent to say to us today?

We hope this volume inspires you to slow down, dive in, and let these ancient stories whisper something new in your ear. Whether you're a long-time mythology fan or just discovering the Olympians for the first time, there's a place for you here in Eiris.

– THE “IEM” TEAM

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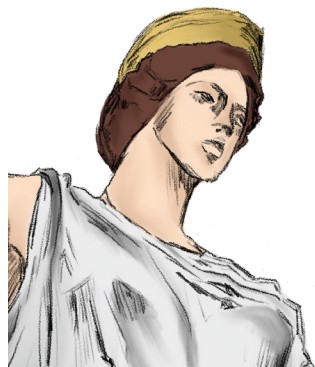
THE GODDESS OF LOVE WHO COULD BREAK HEARTS

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THE WARRIOR GODDESS OF WISDOM



When Hephaestus cleaved Zeus's head open with an axe (in what might be the strangest emergency surgery ever recorded), out came Athena—clad in armor, brandishing a shield, and shouting a war cry that echoed across Olympus.

A GODDESS OF MANY FACES

In the shimmering pantheon of ancient Greek mythology, few deities stand as tall—or as multifaceted—as Athena, the goddess of wisdom, war, and strategy. With her gleaming armor, piercing eyes, and a mind as sharp as her spear, Athena is not just a divine figure; she is a symbol of balance between intellect and power, wisdom and war. While Zeus may have ruled Olympus with thunderbolts, it was often Athena who guided mortals and gods alike with reason, foresight, and skill.

BORN FROM THE MIND OF ZEUS

Athena's birth is one of the most iconic and surreal myths of all time. Unlike other gods born of unions or mortal mothers, Athena sprang fully formed from the head of Zeus. According to the myth, Zeus had swallowed Metis, the goddess of wisdom, fearing a prophecy that her child would overthrow him. But instead of vanquishing that destiny, he internalized it. Days later, he was overcome with a blinding headache.

Though often associated with warfare, Athena was far from a mere combatant. She was the goddess of strategy and just war, as opposed to Ares, who represented the chaotic, bloodthirsty side of battle. Athena fought only when necessary, and always with a calm mind and calculated approach. Her presence on the battlefield was not one of destruction, but of leadership and order.

Yet Athena's influence reached far beyond war. She was the patron of wisdom, crafts, and civilization. Cities worshipped her not for her might alone, but for the knowledge and skills she brought. The ancient city of Athens, named in her honor, stood as a beacon of culture, philosophy, and democracy. It was said that she gifted the olive tree to the people of Attica—a symbol of peace, prosperity, and endurance.

Athena also guided heroes. She mentored Perseus, giving him the polished shield used to defeat Medusa. She aided Odysseus, admired for his cunning, through his

perilous journey home in The Odyssey. Her wisdom was often the secret weapon that tipped the scales of fate.



SYMBOLS AND LEGACY

Athena's symbols reflect her complex nature. The owl, a creature of night and silent vision, represents her insight and knowledge. The aegis, a protective shield often emblazoned with the head of Medusa, symbolizes her role as a guardian. The helmet and spear emphasize her strategic might, while the olive branch shows her love of peace and prosperity.

Today, Athena's legacy is woven into countless as-

pects of Western thought. She appears in literature, philosophy, and modern art. Her dual nature—wise and warlike, nurturing and relentless—resonates with modern ideals of strength tempered by intellect. In an age still grappling with how to balance force and reason, Athena offers a timeless archetype: a leader not ruled by emotion, but guided by wisdom.

A TIMELESS ICON

Athena is not just a figure of the ancient world; she is a symbol of what we still aspire to be—wise, courageous, and just. Whether carved in stone or invoked in classrooms, boardrooms, and courts of justice, her presence endures. In every act of diplomacy, every strategy laid with care, every battle fought for a just cause, we can still hear the whisper of the goddess of wisdom and war.



Let them all die so, all who do such things.
But my heart breaks for Odysseus,
That seasoned veteran cursed by fate so long—
Far from his loved ones still, he suffers torments.

Athena



We are ancient children, primal in our right. No god dares cast us out.

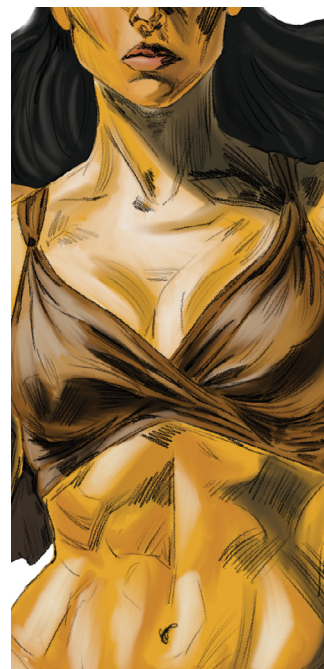
— *The Eumenides, Aeschylus*



ERINYES

Erinyes

AVENGERS OF BLOOD AND JUSTICE



In the shadowy corners of ancient Greek myth, where morality blurs and justice cries out for retribution, dwell the Erinyes—also known as the Furies. Neither fully divine nor merely monstrous, these fearsome figures represent the inescapable grip of guilt and the relentless pursuit of justice. With serpent hair, eyes that drip blood, and voices that drive mortals mad, the Erinyes were not to be taken lightly. They were the personification of vengeance itself—primordial forces born not to forgive, but to punish.

BORN FROM BLOOD AND CHAOS

Unlike the polished, Olympian gods, the Erinyes belong to an older, darker gener-

ation of deities. According to Hesiod's *Theogony*, they were born from the blood of Uranus, the sky god, when he was castrated by his son Cronus. As the blood soaked the earth (Gaia), it gave rise to the Erinyes, alongside the Giants and the Meliae (ash tree nymphs). From their very birth, they were tied to violence, betrayal, and primal justice.

They are typically depicted as three sisters—Alecto ("unceasing"), Tisiphone ("avenger of murder"), and Megaera ("the grudging one")—though their numbers can vary depending on the source. Together, they haunted the guilty, especially those who had committed crimes against their own blood: murder, perjury, and offenses against family loyalty.

FACES OF RIGHTEOUS FURY

Unlike capricious gods who punished mortals for petty slights or personal amusement, the Erinyes were agents of moral order. They didn't hunt just anyone—they pursued those who had broken sacred taboos, especially blood crimes. If a son killed his mother, or a brother betrayed a sibling, the Erinyes would come for him. No prayer, sacrifice, or bribe could stop them. Once marked by their gaze, the guilty would face sleepless torment, hallucinations, and madness.

Their methods were psycho-

logical as much as physical. Victims would be driven to insanity by guilt and fear. In this way, the Erinyes weren't just monsters—they were manifestations of conscience and justice, the divine embodiment of moral reckoning.

IN THE COURT OF JUSTICE

One of the most striking appearances of the Erinyes in literature is in Aeschylus's tragedy *The Eumenides*, the final play of the *Oresteia* trilogy. Here, Orestes, having avenged his father Agamemnon by



killing his mother Clytemnestra, is pursued by the Erinyes. The cycle of vengeance seems endless—until the goddess Athena intervenes. She sets up a court of law

in Athens, where Orestes is tried, and the Erinyes are confronted with the idea of rational justice replacing endless blood revenge. In a surprising twist, the



Erinyes are transformed. Athena offers them a new role—not as tormentors, but as protectors of justice and order in the city. They are renamed the Eumenides, or "the Kindly Ones," a euphemistic name reflecting their new purpose. The myth suggests a cultural evolution: from tribal vengeance to civilized law.

FEAR, REVERENCE, AND RESPECT

Their power was not in brute force, but in the moral weight they carried. They reminded mortals and gods alike that actions have consequences, that even the most powerful are not above justice, and that some debts cannot be ignored.

A R E S

THE UNTAMED GOD OF WAR

In the swirling chaos of the battlefield, where blood soaks the earth and steel meets bone, there is one deity who thrives—Ares, the Greek god of war. Unlike his sister Athena, who represents strategic warfare and calculated defense, Ares embodies raw, unbridled combat—violence in its most primal form. Feared, often loathed, yet undeniably captivating, Ares is the personification of rage, conflict, and masculine aggression.

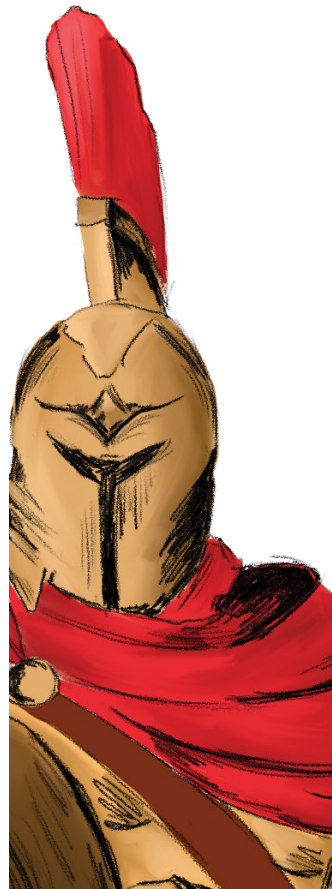
BORN TO OLYMPUS, RAISED IN FURY

Ares was the son of Zeus, king of the gods, and Hera, queen of Olympus. Yet despite his noble parentage, he was never the favorite child. In fact, Zeus is said to have openly despised him, calling him the most hateful of all the gods. This disdain wasn't necessarily for his strength, but for his impulsiveness—his thirst for blood and his disruptive presence among gods and mortals alike.

Where Athena planned her wars, Ares simply charged into battle, driven by instinct and fury. He was not interested in justice or cause; he was the storm of war itself, descending upon armies to stoke the fire of combat.

LOVER, FIGHTER, OUTCAST

Despite his brutal nature,



Ares was not without passion. He had a notorious love affair with Aphrodite, the goddess of love, even though she was married to Hephaestus, the god of craftsmanship. Their affair became legendary—not for its romance, but for its scandal. In one myth, Hephaestus catches the lovers in a golden net and exposes them to the ridicule of Olympus.

This duality—the union of love and war—is central to Ares's character. He represents the dangerous allure of violence, the way conflict can intoxicate and seduce.

His children, too, reflect this nature: Phobos (fear), Deimos (terror), Eros (desire), and Harmonia (harmony), all born from his union with Aphrodite, symbolize the conflicting forces he embodies.

NOT A HERO'S GOD

In classical Greek literature, Ares is rarely portrayed as noble or wise. In *The Iliad*, Homer presents him as reckless and destructive, a force who doesn't discriminate between friend and foe. He fights on the side of the Trojans but is ultimately wounded and driven from the battlefield by Athena—a scene that humiliates the god of war and elevates the value of intellect over brute strength.

Yet even in disgrace, Ares is never weak. He is chaos incarnate, and chaos cannot be contained. His defeats make him more human, more dangerous, more reflective of the ugly truth about war that the Greeks—veterans of their own frequent conflicts—understood all too well.

SYMBOLS AND WORSHIP

Ares is usually depicted as a handsome, muscular man clad in armor, with a spear and shield. His sacred animals include the vulture and the dog, both scavengers of war. Unlike other major Olympians, Ares had few temples in Greece. His

worship was more common in Sparta and Thrace, regions known for their warrior culture and love of battle.

Interestingly, the Romans embraced Ares in a way the Greeks never did. Renamed Mars, he became a national hero—patron of the Roman Empire, father of Romulus and Remus, and a symbol of militaristic pride. This evolution from Greek pariah to Roman icon speaks volumes about how cultures interpret war.



To me, war is not pain—it is joy. Not duty—but hunger.
—Official interpretation of Ares' nature

MAP OF ANCIENT GREECE





But Poseidon, the Earth-Shaker, stayed away... for he was still furious with godlike Odysseus.

—Homer, *Odyssey*

POSEIDON

LORD OF THE DEEP, MASTER OF STORMS



instrument of power. With it, he could shatter cliffs, stir oceans into fury, and even cause earthquakes, earning him the title "Earth-Shaker." The Greeks believed tremors and tsunamis were signs of his displeasure, a terrifying reminder of how small mortals truly were.

Yet Poseidon's domain wasn't limited to destruction. He was also a creator. In myth, he shaped islands from sea foam and raised cities from the waves. He even competed with Athena to become the patron of Athens, striking the Acropolis with his trident to produce a saltwater spring. Though Athena's olive tree won the contest, the story reflects Poseidon's ambition and might.

THE MANY FACES OF THE SEA

Poseidon's personality is as vast and layered as the ocean itself. He could be generous—bestowing calm seas and fresh springs. He was the protector of fishermen, sailors, and merchants, who prayed to him before journeys and built temples along coasts and harbors.

But he was also vengeful, quick to anger when slighted. When the Trojan hero Odysseus blinded his son, the Cyclops Polyphemus, Poseidon unleashed years of misfortune and stormy seas upon him, delaying his return home in Homer's *Odyssey*. Unlike gods who guided through wisdom or law,

Poseidon commanded through awe and fear. His realm was not a court or a battlefield, but a shifting world of tides, currents, and chaos.

MYTHS, OFFSPRING, AND LEGACY

Poseidon's affairs were as tempestuous as his moods. He fathered countless children—gods, giants, monsters, and heroes. Among them were Theseus, the great Athenian hero; Triton, a merman who often served as his herald; and Pegasus, the winged horse born from the blood of Medusa. He also created the first horse, molding it from sea foam as a gift to mankind—or as part of his attempts to woo Demeter, depending on the myth.

His symbols—the trident, the horse, the dolphin—capture the essence of his power: mighty, fluid, and deeply connected to the natural world. Temples to Poseidon were built near the sea, the most famous being the Temple of Poseidon at Cape Sounion, perched dramatically above the Aegean.

POSEIDON IN MODERN CULTURE

Though his name may not appear as often as Zeus or Hades in modern storytelling, Poseidon's influence looms large. He appears in literature, films, and games—from Homer's epics to Rick Riordan's *Percy Jackson*

series, where he is reimagined as a powerful, sometimes distant, but ultimately protective father figure.

His character offers a rich metaphor for human emotion and the natural world: unpredictable, immense, and beyond our control. In an age of climate change, rising seas, and environmental reckoning, Poseidon's presence feels as relevant as ever—a reminder of the power of nature and the price of our arrogance.



APHRODITE

THE GODDESS OF LOVE WHO COULD BREAK HEARTS

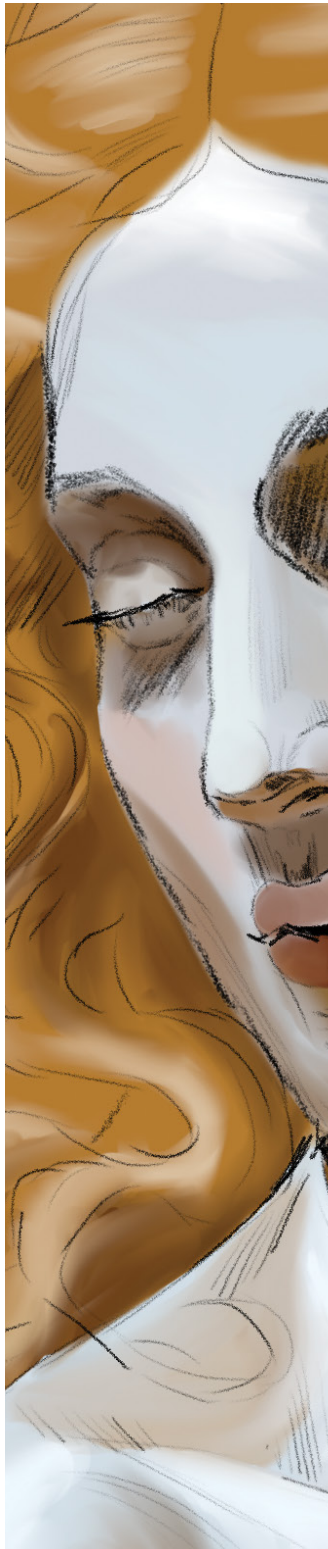
She rises from the sea in a shimmer of foam, unearthly in her beauty, irresistible in her charm. Aphrodite, the Greek goddess of love, beauty, pleasure, and desire, is one of mythology's most iconic and enduring figures. Yet beneath the soft glow of romance and allure lies a deity of immense power—one whose influence could spark wars, shape destinies, and turn gods and mortals alike into pawns of passion.

BORN OF SEA AND SKY

Aphrodite's origin is as poetic as her presence. According to Hesiod's *Theogony*, she was born when the Titan Cronus severed Uranus's genitals and cast them into the sea. From the mingled foam, Aphrodite emerged fully formed, stepping onto the shores of Cyprus. Her name—derived from *aphros*, meaning “foam”—speaks to her divine and mysterious birth.

Other myths, especially later ones, claim she is the daughter of Zeus and Dione, perhaps to integrate her more smoothly into the Olympian hierarchy. But make no mistake—Aphrodite is a primordial force, older and more elemental than many of her divine peers. She doesn't just oversee love—she is love.

BEAUTY THAT BENDS THE WORLD



To see Aphrodite was to desire. Her beauty was so dazzling that even the gods were wary of her. She was married to Hephaestus, the lame god of fire and metalwork, in a union meant to neutralize the jealousies of the Olympian court. But Aphrodite's heart—and body—wandered freely.

Her most famous affair was with Ares, god of war. The contrast couldn't be more striking: love and violence, beauty and brutality. Yet they were a natural pair, producing children that symbolized both passion and peril—Phobos (Fear), Deimos (Terror), Eros (Desire), and Harmonia (Harmony). It's a reminder that Aphrodite's domain isn't just about flirtation—it's about intensity, longing, obsession, and sometimes, destruction.

THE POWER TO START WARS

No story better illustrates Aphrodite's influence than the myth of the Judgment of Paris, the event that ultimately led to the Trojan War. When asked to judge which goddess was the fairest—Hera, Athena, or Aphrodite—Paris of Troy chose Aphrodite, who had promised him the most beautiful mortal woman in the world: Helen of Sparta.

This divine bribe set off a chain of events that would topple kingdoms and stain the Aegean with blood. In this tale, Aphrodite is not

a passive beauty, but a political force, showing how love and desire can drive history. Her gifts are sweet, but they come with a cost.

WORSHIP, SYMBOLS, AND SANCTUARIES

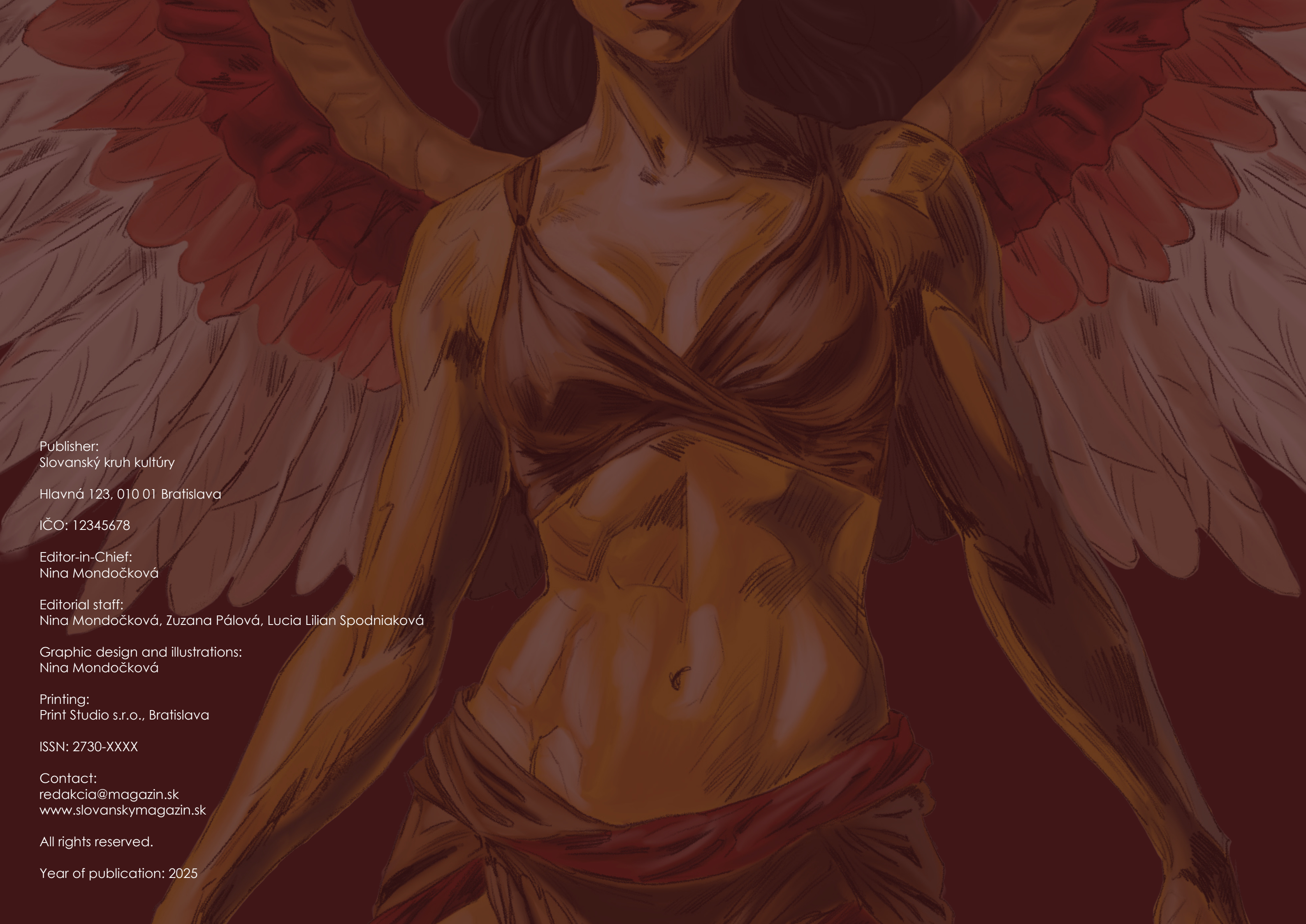
Aphrodite was widely worshipped throughout the Greek world, from Cyprus to Corinth, and later integrated seamlessly into Roman religion as Venus. Her sacred symbols include the dove, rose, swan, myrtle, and mirror—each reflecting different facets of her power: peace, beauty, transformation, and self-reflection.



I am no mortal woman. I am Aphrodite, daughter of Zeus, and I have come to you because the gods willed it.

— Homeric Hymn to Aphrodite





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Editor-in-Chief:
Nina Mondočková

Editorial staff:
Nina Mondočková, Zuzana Pálová, Lucia Lilian Spodniaková

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redakcia@magazin.sk
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**“THE MYTHS ARE NOT
STORIES OF THE PAST—
THEY ARE MIRRORS OF
THE SOUL.”**

- Inspired by Carl Jung & mythological thought



ČASOPIS

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Nina Mondočková